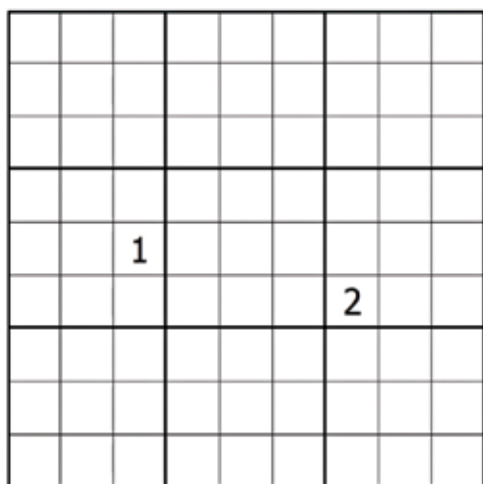


Zoom in to sudoku



The Miracle by Mitchell Lee

Normal Sudoku rules apply. Any two cells separated by a knight's move or a king's move (in chess) cannot contain the same digit. Any two orthogonally adjacent cells cannot contain consecutive digits.



As the pandemic continues to rage, the world stuck at home are finding themselves engaged with things that they would never have dreamed of before

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CRACKING THE CRYPTIC: A

little known puzzling channel broke into the public consciousness with a Sudoku that is insanely difficult to solve, known as the miracle Sudoku. The puzzle is set by Mitchell Lee, and apart from the basic rules of Sudoku, which is that the same number should not repeat within the same box or the same row, or the same column, there are a few extra rules. If a cell has a number, then the same number cannot be a knight's move or a king's move away from it. The moves are from chess. Also, the cell cannot have a number before or after it, in the next cell along the same row or column. This is actually a puzzle that can be solved, even though it starts off with only two numbers. The

conditions are actually very limiting, and after a slow start, the puzzle snowballs towards a solution very rapidly. The pacing of new video uploads on the channel is incredible, with two videos put out everyday, both recorded live. Simon Anthony, who quit his job as an investment banker to follow his passion of puzzling and started a YouTube channel, must have never anticipated the response during the lockdown, that hundreds of thousands of people would stay riveted to a screen, watching a man work his way through a number puzzle. The frenetic pacing of the video uploads continue, with Anthony taking on increasingly stranger and difficult to solve puzzles in the follow up videos. We had no idea that Sudoku had so many interesting rule variants, and in fact, have found ourselves a new hobby in the puzzles hosted on the website by the channel.



BOLLYWOOD ON CHARTS:

Billboard put out an article showing how the music listening habits in India changed drastically after the lockdown. Apparently, people ditched all the latest tracks from new movies,

and decided to rediscover the classics by Kishore Kumar, Mohammad Rafi and Lata Mangeshkar. The source is behind a paywall, but people could see the change in the charts offered by music streaming services, as well as musicplus.in which has a weekly comparison of songs across streaming services. While the pause of the Bollywood hype machine, the closure of movie theatres and the lack of new releases may all have been a factor, the playback singer Sonu Nigam in a Facebook live had a funny take on the whole thing. According to him, the changes in the charts was because music distributors and movie studios stopped making the transactions that they usually do to make sure that their tracks get sufficient exposure and airplay time across the various channels. We prefer to listen to up and coming local artists, which you can do by subscribing to the Radar India playlist on Spotify.



VIDEOS BY PARENTS: A

rather unexpected consequences of the lockdown is that parents are turning into memelords, and the subject matter is their children. These are on all platforms, including Twitter, YouTube and even TikTok. These include families dancing, funny moments of little children, or hilarious pranks such as getting kids to go and wait outside for a schoolbus on April 1, while keeping the camera rolling. At times, it can just be a ridiculous amount of effort towards doing something genuinely cool for their children, like the British Journalist who threw a fancy dinner party for his young kids, and played the role of a very attentive waiter to perfection. It was glorious to see milk poured in a wine glass, something we wished was served to us as well. These are the parents making the best